



Rotorua

A region of New Zealand's North Island that boasts an array of geothermal features, such as geysers, colorful hot springs, and bubbling mud pools

A large part of New Zealand's North Island has a volcanic nature and history. Near its center is Lake Taupo, the site of a supervolcano that last erupted about 1,800 years ago, and to the southwest of this is the Tongariro Volcanic Park (see p.275). To the northeast of Lake Taupo is a hotbed of geothermal activity often referred to as Rotorua, although only some of the geothermal features it contains are close to the city of Rotorua itself. In addition to geysers, hot springs, fumaroles, and mud pools, more unusual sights in the region include a hot-water waterfall (the Kakahi Falls), acidic boiling lakes, sinter and marble terraces, a mud volcano, and a mud spa.

▷ SULFUR TERRACES

Some flowing hot springs create stepped terraces by depositing limestone-like minerals and, in this case, yellow sulfur.



terraces of limestone-like material

Mud pool

A mud pool is created by a combination of hot water, steam, and acidic gases from a fumarole dissolving nearby rocks.

Dormant fountain geyser

This is currently inactive due to a fracture lower down in the geyser system.

Fumarole

A hole in the ground that emits steam and gas is called a fumarole.

▽ BRIGHT DEPOSITS

The orange coloration at the edges of this hot spring, one of several in an area called Wai-o-tapu, are caused by deposits of arsenic- and antimony-containing minerals.



colored hot spring

water percolates downward through cracks in rock

spouting geyser

